1163: Cottus gobio

Relevant synonyms	—
Norwegian name	Hvitfinnet steinulke
Feature group	Fishes & amphibians
Expert(s)	Kim Magnus Bærum
Date	2025-12-20

Alpine (ALP)

Occurrence status	Present regularly (PRE)	
Overall conclusion	**Unknown (XX)**	**Unknown**
Range	Unknown (XX)	Unknown
Population	Favourable (FV)	Unknown
Habitat for species	Favourable (FV)	Unknown
Future prospects	Unknown (XX)	

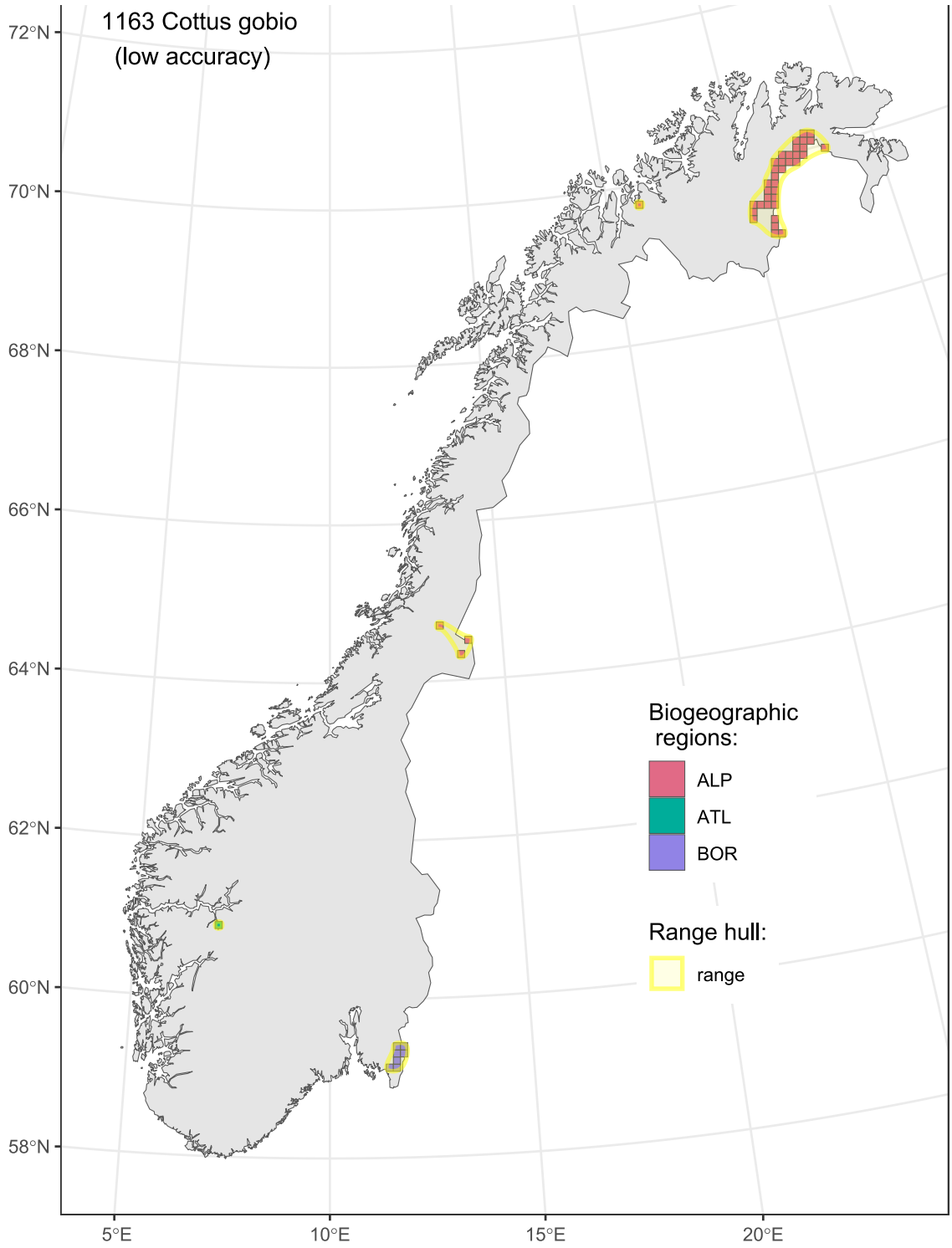
Boreal (BOR)

Occurrence status	Present regularly (PRE)	
Overall conclusion	**Unknown (XX)**	**Unknown**
Range	Unknown (XX)	Unknown
Population	Unknown (XX)	Unknown
Habitat for species	Favourable (FV)	Unknown
Future prospects	Unknown (XX)	

Data sources, references

- Heggberget, T.G., Staldvik, F., Saksgård, R., Sandlund, O.T., Hesthagen, T. & Kjellberg, G. 2015. Kartlegging av fiskearter i og nær Tunnsjøen, med spesiell vekt på forekomst av hvitfinnet steinulke, Cottus gobio L.- NINA Rapport 1118.
- https://artsdatabanken.no/arter/takson/26364
- Cottus gobio knowledge remains limited in Norway . According to the Norwegian Biodiversity Information Centre (NBIC), the species' natural occurrence is associated with three catchments in southern Norway: Store Le and the Halden watercourse (both in Østfold; BOR), and Muruelva (Trøndelag; ALP). Across these systems, the total occupied area is estimated at approximately 39 km².
- The population in Trøndelag (Tunnsjøen and Muruelva) is likely the result of east–west expansion from Sweden. Sweden reported C. gobio for the ALP region. In the most recent reporting period (2013–2018), Sweden reported only range and population (at 1 × 1 km resolution), while other parameters were assessed as "N/A" in the ALP region. Given the apparent ongoing colonisation from the east, it is scientifically reasonable for Norway to apply the same reporting approach for the ALP region.
- A further population has been recorded in northern Norway in the River Tana along the Finnish border (Finnmark; ALP). This occurrence may be human-mediated (e.g., introduction via use of live bait). Finland does not report C.

gobio in the ALP region, and no Natura 2000 sites have been designated for the species in ALP. Taken together, this suggests it is not appropriate to include the Tana population in the ALP-region assessment for Norway.



The map is based on officially registered occurrences (https://artskart.artsdatabanken.no/) complemented with species distribution modelling using ECoMAP / mixglm. Non-experts may confu the species with Cottus poecilopus, leading to misidentification and potential misclassification in the field. There are also too few data points to determine whether the distribution maps are representative. Consequently, the maps are treated as largely uncertain and potentially inaccurate